

1 ENGROSSED HOUSE
2 BILL NO. 2210

By: Lay, Hill, Ranson, and
Archer of the House

3 and

4 Seifried of the Senate
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8 [career and technology education - youth
9 apprenticeship programs - applicable age range -
10 high school students - Department of Career and
11 Technology Education - apprenticeship coordinators
12 - duties - workplace mentors - Secretary of
13 Education - reports - funds - noncodification -
14 effective date -

15 emergency]
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18 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

19 SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 14-127, is
20 amended to read as follows:

21 Section 14-127. A. The Oklahoma Legislature, recognizing the
22 need for improved methods of helping ~~secondary students~~ youth
23 sixteen (16) to twenty-five (25) years of age make a ~~smooth~~
24 meaningful transition from high school to the workplace, hereby

1 establishes guidelines for youth apprenticeship programs. It shall
2 be the responsibility of the Oklahoma Department of Career and
3 Technology Education to establish a state-certified apprenticeship
4 program. The State Board of Career and Technology Education shall
5 establish the rules to carry out the state apprenticeship program.

6 B. Youth apprenticeship programs shall be defined as learning
7 programs for young people enrolled in vocational education that
8 combine ~~on-the-job~~ work-based learning with classroom instruction,
9 that offer a bridge between secondary and post-high-school training
10 and education, and that result in certification of mastery of work
11 skills.

12 C. A high school student may begin participation in an
13 apprenticeship beginning in the eleventh grade. Students who do not
14 begin participation during the eleventh grade may enter a pre-
15 apprenticeship or a full apprenticeship during the twelfth grade,
16 subject to employer need and program design. Students must be at
17 least sixteen (16) years of age to begin paid employment at a
18 workplace, but related instruction may be completed before a student
19 turns sixteen (16) years of age. High school students who enter an
20 state-certified apprenticeship program shall be given equal credit
21 to an Oklahoma CareerTech-approved full-time postsecondary program.

22 D. The Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education
23 shall fund apprenticeship coordinators. Apprenticeship coordinators
24 shall serve as the main liaison among school districts, industry

1 consortia, and hosting employers. Apprenticeship coordinators shall
2 also be responsible for guiding apprenticeship approval, providing
3 technical assistance to employers, site-based mentors, and school
4 districts, collecting site-level data on approved apprenticeships,
5 forming industry consortia, and chairing semi-annual industry
6 consortia meetings. Apprenticeship coordinators shall have a
7 caseload of apprenticeships to manage at their sites. After the
8 first year of operation, the Oklahoma Department of Career and
9 Technology Education may move apprenticeship coordinators based on
10 varying local capacity for apprenticeships. The Oklahoma Department
11 of Career and Technology Education shall work to ensure that
12 apprenticeship opportunities are comparable in rural, suburban, and
13 urban areas.

14 E. A "workplace mentor" refers to an experienced employee who
15 provides direct supervision, instruction, and support for high
16 school apprentices, ensuring that an apprentice receives the skills
17 needed for a recognized credential and a clear pathway to full-time
18 employment in a skilled occupation. Each high school apprenticeship
19 shall have a site-based mentor.

20 F. The Secretary of Education shall provide statewide oversight
21 of all Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education-
22 approved high school apprenticeship programs. An annual report
23 shall be submitted to the Legislature that includes, but is not
24 limited to, the number of high school apprenticeships currently

1 enrolled, the number of high school apprenticeships completed, the
2 estimated return on investment of completed apprenticeships to the
3 state, and capacity differences across rural, suburban, and urban
4 areas of the state.

5 G. The Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education
6 shall contract with an Oklahoma-based external evaluator or
7 Oklahoma-based university researcher to conduct a comprehensive
8 return on investment and impact evaluation of approved high school
9 apprenticeship programs. This evaluation shall be annually
10 submitted to the Secretary of Education to inform the Secretary of
11 Education's annual report to the Legislature. This external
12 evaluation shall be used to make annual funding determinations. The
13 cost of the evaluation shall not exceed Twelve Thousand Dollars
14 (\$12,000.00).

15 H. Youth apprenticeship programs shall be administered and
16 supervised by the State Board of Career and Technology Education,
17 which shall also establish standards for program operation.

18 ~~D.~~ I. Notwithstanding any other section of law, youth
19 apprenticeship programs shall not mean any traditional
20 apprenticeship program registered by the Bureau of Apprenticeship
21 and Training, United States Department of Labor.

22 SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law not to be
23 codified in the Oklahoma Statutes reads as follows:
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There is hereby appropriated to the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education from any monies not otherwise appropriated from the General Revenue Fund of the State Treasury for the fiscal year ending June 30, 2027, the sum of Two Million Dollars (\$2,000,000.00) or so much thereof as may be necessary to perform the duties imposed upon the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education to carry out the youth apprenticeship program as directed in Section 1 of this act.

SECTION 3. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

SECTION 4. It being immediately necessary for the preservation of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

Passed the House of Representatives the 10th day of March, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

Passed the Senate the _____ day of _____, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate